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FOREIGN OFFICE, S.W.1.

Desp. Dept. December 16, 1954.

You telephoned to me the other day about some notes on Formosa for a speech which your Minister is to make tomorrow.

I believe that Mr. Turton has already discussed this briefly with Mr. McNair Snadden, but I hope that the enclosed notes, prepared by the Department, will still be useful. I am sorry that we have not been able to send them to you before.

Yours sincerely,

R. A. RAE.

(Private Secretary to Mr. Turton)

A. T. Rush, Esq.,
Private Secretary to the Joint
Parliamentary Under Secretary,
Scottish Office.

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FORMOSA

The question of the international status of Formosa is technical and complicated. Japan has renounced sovereighty over it, but in our view it has not become part of China. We do not recognize the Chiang Kai-shek régime, and are in no sense parties to the recent United States/Formosa Defence Pact. However, the Prime Minister said in the House of Commons on July 14:

> "I certainly do not see anything in the conduct of China which has yet happened which should lead the American Government to deliver Formosa to Communist China..."

The Minister of State for Foreign Affairs' recent remarks on television were made extempore. They represent no change from our policy as stated by the Foreign Secretary in the House of Commons on December 6 and December 8. Any attack on Formosa might well lead to a wider conflagration which would inevitably involve the United Nations owing to its world-wide responsibilities. We cannot anticipate what decision the United Nations would take. Our chief anxiety is to see the fighting in the area brought to an end. As the Secretary of State said in the House of Commons on December 8: "Our policy is to urge upon all concerned the danger of fighting, the importance of lowering tension and the avoidance of precipitate action".

With regard to the future of Formosa, it is better to avoid references to "neutralization" and "trusteeship" since these only provoke angry retorts from both the Communists and the Nationalists. As the Foreign Secretary said in the House of Commons on December 8, the important thing is to "deal with the situation as it now exists".